

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn

CENTRAL FOCUS

Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn

- [1] Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for selecting problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

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- [2] Gauba shows that disputes in political theory are often methodological before they become ideological. (PDF pp.108-122)

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- [3] It introduces the major traditional approaches—philosophical, historical, legal and institutional—and the later behavioural turn. (PDF pp.112-122)

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- [4] In Optional answers, clean method language often separates average answers from high-scoring answers.

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- [5] Traditional and contemporary are historical labels; they do not exactly coincide with normative and empirical. (PDF pp.109-110)

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- [6] Empirical inquiry studies what can be observed and tested; normative inquiry judges what ought to be preferred or prescribed. (PDF pp.110-112)

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SYNTHESIS -> Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Empirical and Normative Inquiry by Content

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Empirical and Normative Inquiry by Content

[1] He clarifies that empirical vs normative turns on the content of the claim, not just the grammatical presence of "is" or "ought". (PDF pp.110-112)

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[2] He then warns that traditional/contemporary and normative/empirical are not identical pairs. (PDF pp.109-110)

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[3] Gauba begins by separating method from approach so that students do not confuse tools of inquiry with frames of inquiry. (PDF pp.108-109)

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[4] The traditional approaches are then outlined: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)

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[5] The contemporary shift is marked by behaviouralism, post-behaviouralism and several models of political analysis. (PDF pp.117-134)

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[6] The chapter's deeper message is integrative: political science is weakened both by value-blind technique and by unsupported moral assertion.

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v

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Traditional Approaches and Their Thinkers

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Traditional Approaches and Their Thinkers

- [1] Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109)

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- [2] Traditional vs contemporary: the first cluster is associated with philosophy, history, law and institutions, while the second focuses more on process, behaviour and analysis models. (PDF pp.109-110, 117-118)

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- [3] Empirical vs normative: empirical asks what is observable and testable; normative asks what is right, just or preferable. (PDF pp.110-112)

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- [4] Form vs content: a sentence using "ought" may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition, while a sentence using "is" may still be normative if it defines a value like justice. (PDF pp.110-111)

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- [5] Pure science vs relevance: behaviouralism stressed reliable inquiry; post-behaviouralism added action and public responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair

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Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair

- [1] "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its claim can be checked against political functioning. (PDF pp.110-111)

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- [2] "Justice is treating equals equally..." is normative in content even though it appears in the form of an "is" statement. (PDF p.110)

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- [3] Legal analysis of Indian politics would ask what constitutional provisions authorize institutions and actions. (PDF pp.115-116)

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- [4] Institutional analysis would map legislature, executive, judiciary, parties and their formal relations. (PDF pp.116-117)

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- [5] Behavioural analysis of the same political scene would ask how voters, leaders, parties and interest groups actually behave.

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v

SYNTHESIS -> Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

CENTRAL FOCUS

Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

- [1] Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.4, especially PDF pp.108-122 for basic distinctions and the behavioural/post-behavioural debate.

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- [2] Behaviouralism: scientific study of actual behaviour, eight key tenets, micro-level reliability. (PDF pp.118-121)

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- [3] Post-behaviouralism: relevance, action and responsible value concern without discarding scientific gains. (PDF pp.121-122)

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- [4] Best answer line: political inquiry needs both disciplined evidence and defensible value judgment.

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- [5] This basic file reconstructs behaviouralism's eight tenets and all five analytical models (systems, structural-functional, communications/cybernetic, decision-making, Marxian) directly, so it is independently sufficient for full-mark answers; the advanced companion adds further comparative depth and answer-engine prompts.

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SYNTHESIS -> Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets

[1] Exam use: naming these eight in order and pairing two or three with a one-line illustration (e.g. quantification → voting-behaviour surveys; integration → borrowing psychology for leadership studies) earns more marks than a vague "behaviouralism is scientific" line.

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[2] Techniques – rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.

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[3] Quantification – precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.

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[4] Values – an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).

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[5] Systematization – research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.

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SYNTHESIS -> Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action

CENTRAL FOCUS

Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action

- [1] Post-behaviouralism: A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.

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- [2] David Easton: Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

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- [3] Post-behaviouralism, associated with Easton's own self-correction, retains the scientific gains of behaviouralism (rigour, verification, technique) but adds two demands: relevance – political science must address urgent public problems (war, poverty, discrimination, injustice) rather than only tractable micro-questions – and action – intellectuals bear responsibility to apply knowledge for social betterment, not merely to accumulate value-neutral findings. (PDF pp.121-122)

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- [4] Post-behavioural: Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.

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SYNTHESIS -> Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Easton and Almond: Systems and Structural Functions

- [1] Gabriel Almond – structural-functional approach: every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).

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- [2] Reconstruct at least two analytical models (e.g. Easton's systems model and Almond's structural-functional approach, or Deutsch's cybernetic model and the Marxian approach) with claim→evidence→significance→limit each, plus the comparison table's logic.

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- [3] Structural-functional (Almond): Functions performed by variable structures

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- [4] Limit: functionalism's assumption that systems tend toward equilibrium risks a conservative bias (downplaying conflict and structural change), and in practice often measured non-Western systems against a Western liberal-democratic benchmark despite the framework's own claim to be structure-neutral.

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SYNTHESIS -> Easton and Almond: Systems and Structural Functions is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Deutsch, Decision-Making, Marxian Analysis and Model Comparison

- [1] Reconstruct at least two analytical models (e.g. Easton's systems model and Almond's structural-functional approach, or Deutsch's cybernetic model and the Marxian approach) with claim→evidence→significance→limit each, plus the comparison table's logic.

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- [2] Evidence/mechanism: decision-making frameworks (e.g. those used in foreign-policy analysis) break a decision into stages – problem recognition, search for alternatives, evaluation, choice, and implementation – and examine the internal organisational context of the deciding body.

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- [3] Karl Deutsch – communication/cybernetic approach: government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) – decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.

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- [4] Evidence/mechanism: analysis of who owns and controls the means of production is used to explain apparently neutral political institutions (law, bureaucracy, even ideology) as expressions of underlying class interest.

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SYNTHESIS -> Deutsch, Decision-Making, Marxian Analysis and Model Comparison is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

- [1] The decision-making approach can be used to analyse how an Indian policy choice (e.g. a Cabinet or Cabinet Committee decision) moves from problem recognition to implementation, without asserting unverified specifics of any particular real decision unless independently confirmed.

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- [2] Objection: behavioural political science's value-neutrality claim makes it complicit in ignoring urgent injustice, since choosing what to study/ignore is itself a value-laden act. Reply: post-behaviouralism (Easton) does not abandon science in response; it insists that knowledge must be made relevant and put to responsible use while retaining verification and rigour – "action" is added to, not substituted for, evidence standards. (PDF pp.121-122)

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- [3] The structural-functional approach can compare India's formal parliamentary structures with informal interest-articulation channels (caste associations, kinship networks, local patron-client ties) performing the same function in different areas – cite this as a type of comparison, not with unverified statistics.

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- [4] Thesis: political inquiry has moved from traditional/normative approaches to a scientific, and then a value-conscious, contemporary approach.

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SYNTHESIS -> Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

[1] Method: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

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[2] Approach: A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

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[3] Empirical statement: A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

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[4] Normative statement: A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.

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SYNTHESIS -> MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

- [1] Best answer line: political inquiry needs both disciplined evidence and defensible value judgment.

|

v

- [2] This basic file reconstructs behaviouralism's eight tenets and all five analytical models (systems, structural-functional, communications/cybernetic, decision-making, Marxian) directly, so it is independently sufficient for full-mark answers; the advanced companion adds further comparative depth and answer-engine prompts.

|

v

- [3] Limit: functionalism's assumption that systems tend toward equilibrium risks a conservative bias (downplaying conflict and structural change), and in practice often measured non-Western systems against a Western liberal-democratic benchmark despite the framework's own claim to be structure-neutral.

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v

- [4] Method: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

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SYNTHESIS -> PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.